

dent of Apple. However, he was very hesitant. Steve Jobs arranged a meeting with him and asked a question that was destined for fame, “Are you going to sell sugared water for the rest of your life when you could be doing something really important?” John Sculley acquiesced in his request and was declared the new president of Apple Computer, Inc.

The Lisa was launched. It came and disappeared. It was probably the biggest flop in the history of computers. Then there came the commercial that marked Apple as the coolest company in the field of computers and made people impatient to lay their hands on a Macintosh. “When the Super Bowl commercial aired, viewers were treated to an ad unlike any they had seen before. The spot depicted scenes of men with shaved heads dressed in gray, prison-like garb, sitting in rows on long benches, hollow-eyed, watching as a Big Brother-like figure lectures to them from a giant screen. And attractive young blond woman, running from goon oppressors, dashes into the chamber, approaches the screen, spins around to build up momentum with the huge sledgehammer she’s carrying, and then lets it go, smashing into the center of the giant screen, which explodes in a blinding flash of light. At that point, the brief voice-over begins, emphasized by the same words appearing on-screen: ‘On January 24th, Apple Computer will introduce Macintosh. And you’ll see why 1984 won’t be like ‘1984’.

The ad was so spectacular, so distinctively different, so stunningly original that television stations all over the country replayed it on their evening news, giving Apple millions of dollars’ worth of instant free advertising.” (Excerpt from apple-history.com: www.apple-history.com/body.php?page=gallery&model=128k&performa=off&sort=date&order=ASC) On the 24th of that month, the Macintosh was launched by Steve Jobs in front of a large audience. He pulled it out of the small bag it was in and announced, “Now we’ve done a lot of talking about Macintosh recently, but today, for the first time *ever*, I’d like to let Macintosh speak for itself.” In front of a packed audience, the Macintosh introduced itself in what was the most mind-blowing